

encompass the entire width of technology. Similarly when we talk about educational technology, we often think about the equipment that's used to facilitate distance learning, such as mobile apps, or computers, which isn't the case. The Association for Educational Communications and Technology (AECT), the professional society for Education Technology, has a standard definition for it:

*Educational technology is the study and ethical practice of facilitating learning and improving performance by creating, using, and managing appropriate technological processes and resources.*

The earliest reference to the word educational technology is way back from the 1940s, and ever since most writers, researchers and practitioners in the field believe that education technology must focus also on the process of applying tools for educational purposes, and not just the tools and materials. Educational technology can be thought of as composed of two overlapping subsets – technology in education, and technology of education. Overall, as an academic discipline, education technology involves:

- ▶ The learning resources involved, such as messages, people, materials, devices, techniques and settings.
- ▶ Processes for analyzing and devising solutions to problems through research, design, production, and evaluation.
- ▶ The processes involved in organization and personnel management.

Well now that we've got that off of our back, let's move onto actually figuring out how to make e-learning courseware of your own. So what constitutes the process of creating a course that is complete and is accessible by the students? First up, we need to realise that any successful course is comprised of two parts – the content, and the system. The content consists of the courseware that you wish to put across to your students – lessons, quizzes etc. Then, there is the system or the infrastructure that actually enables you to perform all the functional requirements when it comes to managing your students – tracking, reporting, grading, features for online collaboration etc. The software application that usually takes care of these functional requirements is called an LMS.

LMS stands for Learning Management System and it ranges from systems for managing training and records to software for distributing online courses over the internet. LMS is the framework that entirely handles all aspects of the learning process. It is the infrastructure that delivers and manages content, assesses individual and organizational learning goals, keeps track of them, and collects and presents data to represent the learning